

THARAKA DISSANAYAKA

Senior Security Engineer (L2/L3) | Rajagiriya, Colombo, Sri Lanka | +94 76 716 5691 | sandakelum.97@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/tharakadissanayaka](https://www.linkedin.com/in/tharakadissanayaka) | sandakelum97.github.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 7+ years of experience spanning SOC operations, threat detection and response, vulnerability management, and hybrid cloud infrastructure. Currently at Subnet (Australia), delivering managed security across Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon, Sentinel, Entra ID, ThreatLocker, FortiGate, and Nessus TVM for 50+ client tenants. Holds SC-200 (944) and SC-300 (865) certifications. Pursuing an Executive MSc in Information Security and targeting SC-100 and CISSP. Proven in building KQL-based detections, incident response playbooks, phishing simulations, and security automations at scale.

CORE SKILLS

SOC & Threat Detection: Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Proofpoint Email Security, ThreatLocker Application Control, DarkWeb ID

Incident Response & Threat Hunting: AiTM phishing investigation, EDR triage (process injection, AMSI tampering, VSS deletion, LSASS access), adversary emulation, CVE triage & threat intelligence correlation

Vulnerability Management: Nessus TVM, Microsoft Defender TVM, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, remediation tracking & reporting

Identity & Access Management: Microsoft Entra ID, Azure AD, Conditional Access, MFA, RBAC, GPO, Active Directory, Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

Network & Firewall: FortiGate, FortiManager, SonicWall, Auvik, Inforcer, IPSec/SSL VPN, VLANs, Wireshark, PRTG, Cisco CCNA

Tooling & Automation: ConnectWise (PSA/RMM/SIEM), PowerShell, KQL, Google AppSheet, Node.js

Governance & Compliance: ISO 27001, COBIT, NIST CSF, Zero Trust Architecture, change management, security runbook authoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Security Engineer (L2/L3) | Subnet - Australian MSSP. March 2026 - Present

Remote from Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Led threat hunting and alert investigation across Microsoft Defender XDR and CrowdStrike Falcon; triaged EDR detections including process injection, AMSI tampering, VSS deletion, lsass access, and malicious PowerShell.
- Operated and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon prevention policies and managed application control via ThreatLocker (allowlisting, ringfencing, elevation).
- Built and maintained KQL hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel for proactive detection, incident investigation, and client-specific detection rules.
- Managed full phishing lifecycle, email analysis, investigation, and quarantine via Proofpoint; designed and executed phishing simulation campaigns (PhishR) for client end-user awareness.
- Conducted vulnerability management using Nessus TVM and Microsoft Defender TVM, tracking CVE triage and remediation to closure across client tenants.
- Managed FortiGate and FortiManager firewall infrastructure; maintained network visibility through Auvik; enforced configuration compliance via Inforcer.
- Monitored dark web exposure alerts for clients via DarkWeb ID; produced investigation notes, client advisories, and security runbooks via ConnectWise.
- Developed internal tooling, KQL playbooks, and automations to reduce manual SOC workload; authored and maintained operational procedures and incident response documentation.

Senior System & Security Engineer | Chesmi Consolidated (Pvt) Ltd. May 2023 - Feb 2026

▲ Promoted from System & Network Engineer (Feb 2020 - May 2023)

- Architected a modernised data centre using Dell R440 servers and VMware ESXi 7, achieving 99.9% uptime for critical financial operations.
- Fortified network defence for 450+ endpoints by deploying SentinelOne EDR and upgrading SonicWall firewalls, enforcing Zero Trust principles to eliminate lateral movement risks.
- Administered Azure and GCP infrastructure (VMs, vNets, RBAC) and managed Microsoft Dynamics NAV ERP, Power BI, QuickBooks (Cloud), and MS SQL 2019 for 150+ users.
- Enforced IAM policies via Active Directory GPOs and Google Workspace controls; engineered a custom ITSM platform using AppSheet, reducing MTTR by 50%.
- Managed Windows Servers 2016 - 2022, VMware ESXi v7, QSAN NAS, and disaster recovery procedures; maintained Fortinet and SonicWall firewall and VPN infrastructure.

System & Network Engineer | Chesmi Consolidated (Pvt) Ltd. Feb 2020 - May 2023

- Managed enterprise LAN networks, Windows desktops, printers, and CCTV infrastructure for the organisation.
- Administered company websites (chesmi.com, chelcey.com, littlemiracles.lk), optimising performance and security.
- Leveraged PRTG, Wireshark, and AlienVault OSSIM for network monitoring and event visibility.

Technical Lead (Consultant) | Chelcy Solutions (Pvt) Ltd. Dec 2022 - Dec 2025

- Led a 3-engineer squad delivering customised infrastructure and security solutions for 10+ clients.
- Designed and implemented security measures achieving 99% compliance with industry security frameworks; mentored team members, reducing project delivery timelines by 20%.

IT Technical Support (Part-Time) | Taphouse by RnR. Feb 2020 - Mar 2022

- Implemented and maintained the ZinCat POS system; administered LAN, CCTV, and desktop hardware for business continuity.

IT Assistant | Nation Lanka Finance PLC. Nov 2018 - Feb 2020

- Provided IT support across ESET endpoint administration, LAN infrastructure, and hardware maintenance for 500+ endpoints.

EDUCATION

Executive Master of Science in Information Security (EMSc IS)

Asia e University (CICRA Campus) | Malaysia / Remote | Nov 2025 - Apr 2027

Diploma in Network Engineering

National Institute of Business Management (NIBM) | Sri Lanka | 2023 - 2024 | GPA: 3.76

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft

- SC-200: Microsoft Security Operations Analyst (Score: 944)
- SC-300: Microsoft Identity and Access Administrator (Score: 865)
- AZ-900: Azure Fundamentals
- SC-100: Microsoft Cybersecurity Architect (In Progress)

ISC2 / Cisco / Other

- ISC2: Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)
- Cisco: CCNA, CyberOps Associate, DevNet Associate
- Fortinet: NSE 1, NSE 2, NSE 3 — Network Security Associate
- Google Cloud: Generative AI Leader, Cybersecurity Professional

PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

MSSP SOC Playbooks | GitHub - github.com/sandakelum97/mssp-soc-playbooks

- Open-source KQL hunting queries, incident response runbooks, and EDR investigation checklists built from real MSSP SOC operations.

Purple Team HQ | Lovable / Supabase

- Full-stack certification and study tracker with session timer, academic journey module, and progress dashboards - built to support personal purple team capability development.

Security Awareness Training Platform | Vercel / Supabase / Node.js

- Developed a gamified cybersecurity training platform using Node.js, Express.js, and PostgreSQL (Supabase). Deployed the solution on Vercel with full CI/CD pipeline integration, demonstrating full-stack development capabilities in a security context.

Defender TVM × RMM Cross-Check Tool | Internal Tooling

- Self-contained HTML tool for cross-referencing Microsoft Defender TVM vulnerability findings with ConnectWise RMM asset data, reducing manual reconciliation effort at Subnet.

REFEREES

Mr Yushan Jayasuriya - Manager, Data Engineering, Sampath Bank | +94 71 059 2689 | yushan77777@gmail.com

Mr Suraj Ranasinghe - Director, Operations, Chesmi Consolidated (Pvt) Ltd. | +94 77 254 2334 | suraj@chesmi.com